



Lecture Eight

Introducing C++ I/O System

Ref: Herbert Schildt, Teach Yourself C++, Third Edⁿ (Chapter 8)



Some C++ I/O Basics

Stream:

- A stream is a **logical device** that either **produces** or **consumes information**.
- A stream is **linked** to a **physical device** by the C++ I/O system.
- All streams behave in the **same manner**, even if the actual physical devices they are linked to differ.
- In C, there are three predefined streams: **stdin**, **stdout** and **stderr**.
- In C++, four predefined stream:

<u>Stream</u>	<u>Meaning</u>	<u>Default Device</u>
cin	Standard input	Keyboard
cout	Standard output	Screen
cerr	Standard error	Screen
clog	Buffered version of cerr	Screen

- C++ has wide character versions: **wcin**, **wcout**, **wcerr** and **wclog**.



Some C++ I/O Basics

Template Class and I/O Classes:

- In the header file **<iostream>**, a complicated set of class hierarchies is defined.
- The I/O classes begin with a system of **template classes**. A template class defines the form of a class **without fully specifying** the data upon which it operates.
- C++ has **two versions** of template class: one for **8-bit character** and another for **wide character**.
- C++ I/O system is build upon **two related but different** template class hierarchies: **basic_streambuf** and **basic_ios**.

Template Class

basic_streambuf

basic_ios

8-bit character based class

streambuf

ios



Some C++ I/O Basics

➤ **basic_streambuf** supplies basic, low-level input and output operations and provides the underlying support for the entire I/O system. **basic_streambuf** is needed for **advanced I/O programming**.

➤ **basic_ios**: A high level class that provides formatting, error checking and status information related to **stream I/O**.

basic_ios is used as a base of several derived classes, including **basic_istream**, **basic_ostream** and **basic_iostream**

<u>Template Class</u>	<u>8-bit character based class</u>
basic_istream	istream
basic_ostream	ostream
basic_iostream	iostream
basic_fstream	fstream
basic_ifstream	ifstream
basic_ofstream	ofstream

Including **<iostream>** in a program, thus, allow access to **ios class**.



Formatting I/O

- Each stream has associated with a set of **format flags** that control the way the information is formatted.
- The **ios class** declares a **bitmask enumeration** called **fmtflags**, in which the following values are defined to set or clear **format flags**.

Collective value	Individual value	Purpose
adjustfield	Left	Output is left justified.
	Right	Output is right justified.
	internal	A numeric value is padded to fill a field by inserting spaces between any sign or base character.
	not set	Default output is right justified.
basefield	Oct	Display output in Octal.
	Dec	To return output to Decimal.
	Hex	Display output in Hexadecimal.
floatfield	Scientific	Display floating point values in scientific notation.
	Fixed	Display floating point values in normal notation.



Formatting I/O

boolalpha	Booleans can be input or output using the keyword true or false .
skipws	Leading whitespace characters (spaces, tabs and newlines) are discarded when input is being performed in a stream.
showbase	The base of numeric values are displayed. For example, if the conversion base is hexadecimal, 1F is displayed as 0x1F.
showpoint	A decimal point and trailing zeros to be displayed for all floating point output - whether needed or not.
showpos	A leading plus sign (+) to be displayed before positive values. This only affects on decimal output.
unitbuf	The buffer is flushed after each insertion operation.
uppercase	The character are displayed uppercase.



Formatting I/O

- To **set** or **clear** one or more **format flags**, the function **setf()** and **unsetf()** are used. Both are the **members of ios**. The general format are:

```
fmtflags setf(fmtflags flags);  
void unsetf(fmtflags flags);
```

An example to **set** the **showbase** and **hex flags** for cout:

```
cout.setf( ios::showbase | ios::hex);
```

As **showbase** is an enumerated constant within the **ios class**, the **scope resolution** operator is used to tell compiler the class name; otherwise, showbase will not be recognized.

- The **member function of ios class flags()** returns the **current setting** of each format flag. Its prototype is:

```
fmtflags flags();
```

Example: `ios::fmtflags f = cout.flags();`

The **second form** of **flags()** function **set all format flags**, its prototype is as follows:

```
fmtflags flags(fmtflags f);
```

- For some compilers, the **dec flag overrides** the other flags, so **it is necessary to turn it off when turning on either hex or oct**.



Formatting I/O

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main(){
    // display using default setting
    cout << 123.23 << " hello " << 100 << "\n";
    cout << 10 << ' ' << -10 << "\n";
    cout << 100.0 << "\n\n";

    cout.unsetf( ios::dec );
    cout.setf( ios::hex | ios::scientific);
    cout << 123.23 << " hello " << 100 << "\n"
    cout.setf( ios::showpos );
    cout << 10 << ' ' << -10 << "\n";
    cout.setf( ios::showpoint | ios::fixed);
    cout << 100.0;

    return 0;
}
```

OUTPUT:

```
123.23 hello 100
10 -10
100
1.232300e+02 hello 64
A fffffff6
+100.000000
```




Formatting I/O

➤ The **member function of ios class flags()** returns the **current setting** of each format flag. Its prototype is:

```
fmtflags flags();
```

Example: `ios::fmtflags f = cout.flags();`

The **second form** of **flags()** function **set all format flags**, its prototype is as follows:

```
fmtflags flags(fmtflags f);
```

➤ For some compilers, the **dec flag overrides** the other flags, so **it is necessary to turn it off when turning on either hex or oct.**

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

void showflags();
```

```
int main(){
    showflags();
    cout.setf(ios::oct | ios::showbase | ios::fixed);
    showflags();
    ios::fmtflags f = ios::showpos | ios::showbase
                     | ios::oct | ios::right;
    cout.flags(f);           // set flags
    showflags();

    return 0;
}
```



Formatting I/O

```
void showflags(){
ios::fmtflags f = cout.flags();    //get flag settings

if ( f & ios::skipws ) cout << "skipws on\n";
else cout << "skipws off\n";
if ( f & ios::left ) cout << "left on\n";
else cout << "left off\n";

if ( f & ios::right ) cout << "right on\n";
else cout << "right off\n";

if ( f & ios::internal ) cout << "internal on\n";
else cout << "internal off\n";

if ( f & ios::dec ) cout << "dec on\n";
else cout << "dec off\n";

if ( f & ios::oct ) cout << "oct on\n";
else cout << "oct off\n";

if ( f & ios::hex ) cout << "hex on\n";
else cout << "hex off\n";

if ( f & ios::showbase ) cout << "showbase on\n";
else cout << "showbase off\n";
```

```
if ( f & ios::showpoint ) cout << "showpoint on\n";
else cout << "showpoint off\n";

if ( f & ios::showpos ) cout << "showpos on\n";
else cout << "showpos off\n";

if ( f & ios::uppercase ) cout << "uppercase on\n";
else cout << "uppercase off\n";

if ( f & ios::scientific ) cout << "scientific on\n";
else cout << "scientific off\n";

if ( f & ios::fixed ) cout << "fixed on\n";
else cout << "fixed off\n";

if ( f & ios::unitbuf ) cout << "unitbuf on\n";
else cout << "unitbuf off\n";

if ( f & ios::boolalpha ) cout << "boolalpha on\n";
else cout << "boolalpha off\n";

cout << '\n';
}
```



Formatting I/O

OUTPUT:

skipws on
left off
right off
internal off
dec on
oct off
hex off
showbase off
showpoint off
showpos off
uppercase off
scientific off
fixed off
unitbuf off
boolalpha off

skipws on
left off
right off
internal off
dec on
oct on
hex off
showbase on
showpoint off
showpos off
uppercase off
scientific off
fixed on
unitbuf off
boolalpha off

skipws on
left off
right on
internal off
dec on
oct on
hex off
showbase on
showpoint off
showpos on
uppercase off
scientific off
fixed on
unitbuf off
boolalpha off



Using width(), precision() and fill()

➤ In addition to the formatting flags, there are **3 member functions** of ios for setting format parameters: **width()**, **precision()** and **fill()**.

Prototypes of these 3 functions are as follows:

```
streamsize width(streamsize w);    // default minimum size
streamsize precision(streamsize p); // default six digits
char fill(char ch);                // default spaces
```

In all cases, the new value set to the given parameter (i.e., w, p or ch) **and** the old value is returned.

✓ **streamsize** is defined in **ios** as some form of **integer**.



Using width(), precision() and fill()

➤ **Field width** is set before each output statement.

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

int main(){
    cout.width(10);
    cout << "hello" << '\n';

    cout.fill('%');
    cout.width(10);
    cout << "hello" << '\n';

    cout.setf(ios::left);
    cout.width(10);
    cout << "hello" << '\n';

    cout.width(10);
    cout.precision(10);
    cout << 123.234567 << '\n';

    cout.width(10);
    cout.precision(6);
    cout << 123.234567 << '\n';

    double x;
    cout.precision(4)
    cout << "    x    sqrt(x)    x^2\n\n";
```

```
for( x =2.0; x<=5; x++){
    cout.width(7);
    cout << x << "    ";
    cout.width(7);
    cout << sqrt(x) << "    ";
    cout.width(7);
    cout << x*x << "    ";
}
return 0;
}
```

OUTPUT:

```
hello
%%%%%hello
hello%%%%%%%%
123.234567
123.235%%%
```

x	sqrt(x)	x*x
2	1.414	4
3	1.732	9
4	2	16
5	2.236	25



Using I/O Manipulators

- The **second way of formatting** I/O information is using special functions called ***manipulators***.
- To access manipulators that takes parameters, such **setw()**, **<iomanip>** **must be included**. This is not necessary if the manipulator does not take arguments.
- If the manipulator **does not take an argument**, **it is not followed by parenthesis**, because it is the **address of the manipulator** that is passed to the overloaded << operator.
- Manipulators are **easier to use** and allow more compact code to be written.
- Specific format **flags of ios** class can be set using manipulator using **setiosflags()** and clear them using **resetiosflags()**.



Using I/O Manipulators

List of manipulators:

Manipulator

Purpose

Input/Output

boolalpha

Turn on boolalpha flag

Input/output

dec

Turn on dec flag

Input/output

endl

Output a newline character and flushes the stream

Output

ends

Output a null

Output

fixed

Turn on fixed flag

Output

flush

Flushes a stream

Output

hex

Turn on hex flag

Input/output

internal

Turn on internal flag

Output

left

Turn on left flag

Output

noboolalpha

Turn off boolalpha flag

Input/output

noshowbase

Turn off showbase flag

Output

noshowpoint

Turn off showpoint flag

Output

noshowpos

Turn off showpos flag

Output

noskipws

Turn off skipws flag

Input

nounitbuf

Turn off unitbuf flag

Output

nouppercase

Turn off uppercase flag

Output

oct

Turn on oct flag

Input/output



Using I/O Manipulators

<code>resetiosflags(fmtflags f)</code>	Turn off the flags specified in f	Input/output
<code>right</code>	Turn on right flag	Output
<code>scientific</code>	Turn on scientific flag	Output
<code>setbase(int base)</code>	Set the number base to base	Input/output
<code>setfill(int ch)</code>	Set the fill character to ch	Output
<code>setiosflags(fmtflags f)</code>	Turn on the flags specified in f	Input/output
<code>setprecision(int p)</code>	Set number of digits of precision	Output
<code>setw(int w)</code>	Set the field width to w	Output
<code>showbase</code>	Turn on showbase flag	Output
<code>showpoint</code>	Turn on showpoint flag	Output
<code>showpos</code>	Turn on showpos flag	Output
<code>skipws</code>	Turn on skipws flag	Input
<code>unitbuf</code>	Turn on unitbuf flag	Output
<code>uppercase</code>	Turn on uppercase flag	Output
<code>ws</code>	Skips leading white space	Input



Using I/O Manipulators

```
#include <iostream>
#include <iomanip>
using namespace std;

int main(){
    cout << hex << 100 << endl;
    cout << oct << 10 << endl;
    cout << setfill('X') << setw(10);
    cout << 100 << " hi " << endl;

    double x;
    cout << setprecision(4);
    cout << "    x    sqrt(x)    x^2\n\n";
    for( x = 2.0; x <= 5.0; x++ ){
        cout << setw(7) << x << " ";
        cout << setw(7) << sqrt(x) << " ";
        cout << setw(7) << x*x << " ";
    }
    return 0;
}
```

OUTPUT:

64

12

XXXXXXXX144 hi

x	sqrt(x)	x*x
2	1.414	4
3	1.732	9
4	2	16
5	2.236	25



Creating your own Inserters

➤ In C++, the **output operation** is called an **insertion** and the **<<** is called the **insertion operator**.

➤ All insertion function or inserter has the following general form:

```
ostream &operator << (ostream &stream, class-name ob){  
    //body of inserter  
    return stream;  
}
```

➤ The **first parameter** is a **reference to output stream** and the **second parameter** is the object to be displayed. The function returns an output stream.

➤ An **inserter** cannot be a member of a class, because for an operator member function the **left operand must be an object** which is implicitly passed through this pointer.

➤ An **inserter** can be a **friend function**.

➤ An inserter should be written **as general as possible**.



Creating your own Inserters

Inserter using friend function.

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

class coord {
    int x, y;
public:
    coord (int i = 0, int j = 0) { x = i; y = j; }
    friend ostream &operator << ( ostream
                                &stream, coord ob);
};

ostream &operator << ( ostream &stream,
                      coord ob){
    stream<<ob.x<< ' ', '<<ob.y<<'\n';
    return stream;
}

int main(){
    coord a(1, 1), b(10, 23);
    cout << a << b;
    return 0;
}
```

Without using friend function. Variable x and y must be public.

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

class coord {
public:
    int x, y;
    coord (int i = 0, int j = 0) { x = i; y = j; }
};

ostream &operator << ( ostream &stream,
                      coord ob){
    stream<<ob.x<< ' ', '<<ob.y<<'\n';
    return stream;
}

int main(){
    coord a(1, 1), b(10, 23);
    cout << a << b;
    return 0;
}
```



Creating Extractor

- In C++, the **input operation** is called an **extraction** and the **>>** is called the **extraction operator**.
- All insertion function or inserter has the following general form:

```
istream &operator >> (istream &stream, class-name ob){  
    //body of inserter  
    return stream;  
}
```

The **first parameter** is a **reference to input stream** and the **second parameter** is the **object** to be displayed. The function returns an **input stream**.

- An **extractor** cannot be a member of a class, because for an operator member function the **left operand must be an object** which is implicitly passed through this pointer.
- An extractor can be a **friend function**.
- An extractor should be written as general as possible.



Creating Extractor

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

class inventory {
    char item[40];
    int onhand;
    double cost;
public:
    inventory (char *i, int o, double c ) {
        strcpy(item, i);
        onhand = o;
        cost = c;
    }
    friend ostream &operator << ( ostream
                                &stream, inventory ob);
    friend istream &operator >> ( istream
                                &stream, inventory &ob);
};

ostream &operator << ( ostream &stream,
                    inventory ob){
    stream << ob.item << ": " << ob.onhand;
    stream << " on hand at $" << ob.cost << "\n";
    return stream;
}
```

```
istream &operator >> ( istream &stream,
                    inventory &ob){
    cout << "Enter the item name: ";
    stream >> ob.item;
    cout << "Enter number on hand: ";
    stream >> ob.onhand;
    cout << "Enter cost: ";
    stream >> ob.cost;

    return stream;
}

int main(){
    inventory ob("hammer", 4, 12.55);

    cout << ob;
    cin >> ob;
    cout << ob;

    return 0;
}
```



Creating own Manipulators

- Custom manipulators are **important for two reasons**: (1) consolidate a sequence of several separate I/O operations. This **simplifies** the source code and **prevents accidental errors**; and (2) when need to perform I/O operations on a **nonstandard device**.
- **Two types of manipulators**: (1) those that operate on **input stream**; and (2) those that operate on **output stream**.
- **Two types of manipulators**: (1) manipulators **taking arguments**; and (2) manipulators **not taking arguments**. Manipulators taking arguments are out of scope of this book.
- **General form of all parameterless manipulator output function:**

```
ostream &manip-name(ostream &stream){  
    // body  
    return stream;  
}
```

General form of all parameterless manipulator input function:

```
istream &manip-name(istream &stream){  
    // body  
    return stream;  
}
```



Creating own Manipulators

```
#include <iostream>
using namespace std;

ostream &setup ( ostream &stream ){
    stream.width(10);
    stream.precision(4);
    stream.fill('*');

    return stream;
}

int main(){
    cout << setup << 123.123456;

    return 0;
}
```